



Gaming Monitors

A more holistic experience awaits

What's the point of getting a high-end PC with a powerful CPU and graphics card, if you're not going to pair it with a good monitor? With graphics cards as well as CPUs becoming increasingly overpowered, display manufacturers can build monitors with higher refresh rates than ever before. However, this year, we've seen a more holistic approach as gaming monitors have started incorporating system latency measuring capabilities to help gamers better optimise their gaming experience. Panels have started improving, HDR is present in most monitors north of ₹30K and refresh rates have gotten even higher. And this year's Zero1 Award winner is a great example of this combination.

Winner: ASUS ROG Swift 360Hz PG259QNR

Up until last year, we had to pick between a high refresh panel or a panel with high colour accuracy. Getting the two together wasn't an easy task. This year, that changed with the Zero1 Award winner. Now, the choice is between getting a high refresh-rate coupled with colour accuracy against resolution. Mainstream gaming is still on 1080p, at least that's what the Steam Hardware survey says with a whopping 67 per cent of gamers still running their games at 1080p. However, 1440p is slowly becoming popular. Most of our candidates were 1440p panels and hopefully, we should see a 1440p 360 Hz next year. The ASUS ROG Swift PG259QNR is a 360 Hz gaming monitor with NVIDIA G-Sync and NVIDIA REFLEX. It uses an IPS panel with HDR10 support and has great ergonomics which is bound to make the monitor very appealing to gamers. And the 360 Hz refresh rate makes it attractive for eSports professionals as well. And when it comes to colour, the PG259QNR is very colour accurate with a colour delta of less than 0.5. This is the monitor that a professional FPS eSports athlete would want.



**ASUS ROG
Swift 360Hz
PG259QNR**

Price: ₹73,499



Runner Up: Acer Predator XB323U

This year's first runner up is the Acer Predator XB323U which is a QHD 165 Hz monitor with support for VESA HDR600. In terms of colour accuracy, the XB323U is not far behind the winner and a larger 32-inch makes the monitor ideal for not only PC gaming but also for folks who'd like to play from a little farther away. The native refresh rate is 144 Hz but it comes overclocked to 170 Hz right off the factory floor. It supports FreeSync as well as G-SYNC so it doesn't matter which GPU you have, you can utilise the variable refresh rate tech without worry. Being a VESA HDR600 monitor also makes the Acer Predator XB323U ideal for HDR gaming during the day as well as during night time. Overall, it's a great gaming monitor for enthusiasts.



**Acer Predator
XB323U**

Price: ₹61,299



**BenQ MOBIUZ
EX2710Q**

Price: ₹35,990

Best Buy: BenQ MOBIUZ EX2710Q

BenQ's portfolio always reflects what gamers want. They tend to have a wide variety of monitors or peripherals with just one or two aspects being different. Take for example the MOBIUZ monitors. If you want a curved screen then there's the EX2710R and if you want a flat panel, then there's the EX2710Q. With gaming mice, they'll have multiple models which only vary in terms of the grip style while the internals remain the same. It's that ergonomics-first approach that makes their product portfolio more appealing. And you get all that without breaking the bank. This year's Best Buy, the EX2710Q is also a 27-inch 1440p IPS monitor with VESA HDR400 and also includes several features within the OSD menu that can be triggered to improve your gaming experience.

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